Question:

A 29-year-old man presents to his primary care provider complaining of testicular pain. He reports a four-day history of dull chronic pain in his left testicle that is worse with standing. His past medical history is notable for asthma and major depressive disorder. He takes inhaled albuterol as needed and sertraline. He is sexually active with a single female partner and always uses barrier protection. His temperature is 99.2°F (37.3°C), blood pressure is 125/75 mmHg, pulse is 85/min, and respirations are 17/min. Physical examination reveals a non-tender twisted mass along the left spermatic cord that disappears when the patient lies supine. This patient’s condition most likely stems from decreased laminar flow at which of the following vascular junctions?

Answer Choices:

A. Left testicular vein – Left renal vein

B. Left testicular vein – Inferior vena cava

C. Descending aorta – Left testicular artery

D. Left testicular vein – Left internal iliac vein

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

To approach this reasoning problem, we need to analyze the context of the question, which is centered around the medical condition of a patient presenting with testicular pain, likely indicative of a condition known as testicular torsion. The question specifically asks about the vascular junction affected by decreased laminar flow, which is a key diagnostic factor for this condition. The correct answer is the one that describes the specific anatomical location where this occurs, which is the connection between the left testicular vein and the inferior vena cava, a condition that can lead to the twisted mass observed in the patient.</think>

<answer>

Left testicular vein âĢĵ Inferior vena cava

</answer>